



Strategy & Legal Operations

The Strategy & Legal Ops team promotes and institutes streamlined processes, efficient tools, and centralized program management to ensure LACA remains agile and able to support every area of GitLab's business.

Check out [our issue board](#) to learn more about what we're working on.

Objectives

1. **Strategic Planning and Financials:** Build, execute, and iterate on a best-in-class strategic plan, including management of LACA's budget from planning through forecasting and reporting.
2. **Legal Operations:** Optimize LACA operations through tools, processes, and operational capabilities. Drive enhancements to the [LACA tech stack](#).
3. **Program and Project Management:** Define and drive initiatives spanning across LACA and GitLab. Examples include: vendor management, [billing and accruals](#), [designated insiders and pre-clearance process](#), tool administration, and team member engagement activities.

Legal Billing Process

GitLab uses Brightflag's Legal Spend Management platform to process and review legal invoices and accruals.

See the [Brightflag invoicing process](#) in the internal handbook.

Accruals Process

Accruals submission reminder notifications are automatically sent through Brightflag to ensure vendors submit their accruals on time.

- Law firms with active matters will receive two automated reminder emails at 06:15 UTC on the following days:
 - **First Reminder:** Five calendar days before the deadline.
 - **Final Reminder:** On the day of the deadline.

- If the deadline falls on a weekend, the email will be sent on that weekend day.
- If accruals are submitted on all matters before the deadline for a given vendor office, the notification emails will not be sent to that vendor.

Legal & Corporate Affairs Expenditure Request Process

This process is designed to enable LACA team members to submit requests related to attending events/conferences, furthering development, or purchasing tools/software funded by LACA. This process does not apply to [equipment](#), [Individual Use Software](#) or other personal reimbursement requests.

- All expenses / reimbursements must be in accordance with [GitLab's Travel & Expense Policy](#).
- All requests for use of LACA funds require approval from applicable stakeholders within the LACA Expenditure Request Issue Template.
- Requests must be submitted, (i) no less than ninety (90) days prior to the event/purchase request date, and (ii) no more than once per year.
- For conferences or development requests, team members are expected to share materials and insight with others within LACA (and GitLab).

Types of Expenditures

- Growth & Development: Team members can review the [Growth & Development Fund](#) and various options available to GitLab team members. *Note: The program would not cover costs associated with travel & expenses, which would be allocated to the LACA budget.*
- Tools / Software: For requests related to new tools or software, a LACA Expenditure Request Issue Template is required.

Expenditure Process Overview

- LACA team members must first communicate their intended request with their manager.
- If supported by their manager, the team member will complete the ["laca-travel-and-expense-request" template](#).
- Included within the LACA Expenditure Request Issue Template are details that the team member must complete.
- Upon being submitted, the request will be reviewed internally by LACA leadership.

- If approved, the request will then be assigned to Finance to ensure applicable funds are available.
- Requests are considered fully approved only when all stakeholder checkboxes have been completed. Please note, all expenses tied to the request must be submitted in accordance with [GitLab's Travel & Expense Policy](#).

Last modified March 18, 2026: [Remove Expenses Public Handbook Page \(c2934665\)](#).

 [View page source](#) -  [Edit this page](#) - please [contribute](#). 